

# Thursday September 17th – morning

09.00 – 09.30 **Reception**

|               |                                                                          |
|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 09.30 – 09.50 | PLENARY Conference Opening - A Espinosa, J Walker, A Leonard             |
| 09.50 – 10:00 | Launching 100 Years Festschrift: A Espinosa, M Schwaninger, J.P. Rios    |
| 10:20 – 10:30 | Stafford Beer- a truly holistic character (A Leonard, V Beer, F Sagasti) |

10.30 - 11:00 **Coffee**

|               | <b>Room A</b><br>Toward Resilient, and<br>Ethical Viable Systems<br>(1)                                                                                         | <b>Room B</b><br>Emerging Methods and<br>Tools (1)                                                             | <b>Room C</b><br>Stafford Beer in Latin<br>America                                                                                                                                                                                      | <b>Room D</b><br>Cybernetics for All<br>(Barefoot Cybernetics)<br>(1)                                                                            |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 11.00 - 11:45 | <b>Angela Espinosa</b><br>Managing Organisational<br>and Societal Complexity<br>for a Fairer and More<br>Sustainable New World                                  | <b>Markus Schwaninger</b><br>CyberSystemic Tools for<br>Organizational<br>Advancement.                         | <b>Víctor Ganón</b><br>From Organisation to<br>State: Adapting,<br>Reinterpreting and<br>Challenging Stafford<br>Beer's Cybernetic Ideas<br>in Public Administration<br>and Democratic<br>Governance — The Case<br>of URUCIB in Uruguay | <b>Clive Holtham</b><br>Learning an outlook –<br>Beer's neglected<br>contribution to<br>reshaping higher<br>education in an AI-<br>infused world |
| 11:45 - 12:15 | <b>Steve Outtrim &amp; David<br/>J. Teece</b><br>Beer-Viable but Teece-<br>Dead: The Viable<br>System Model as the<br>Wiring Diagram of<br>Dynamic Capabilities | <b>Martin Pfiffner</b><br>From Theory to Practice<br>– and Back                                                | <b>Juliana Mariano-Alves</b><br>Transparency as a<br>Trigger for Change:<br>Repercussions of the<br>Viable System Model<br>(VSM) Application on<br>Water Governance in the<br>Tocantins-Araguaia<br>Hydrographic Region                 | <b>Stephen Harwood</b><br>Cybernetics For All<br>(#Cybernetics4All)                                                                              |
| 12:15 - 13:00 | <b>Angus Jenkinson</b><br>Ecocybernetics and the<br>Living Foundations of<br>Beer's Viable System<br>Model                                                      | <b>Vijaya Manchem</b><br>Translating VSM into<br>Practice: A<br>Capability-Led Approach<br>using Microsoft 365 | <b>John Byrne</b><br>Useful Art as a Toolkit<br>for Cybernetic Change:<br>A Viable Systems Model<br>for a Better World Today                                                                                                            | <b>Marc-André Pigeon</b><br>Beer's Pedagogy:<br>Lessons from the<br>Concordia University<br>Lectures                                             |

13.00 - 14.00 **Lunch**

# Thursday September 17th – afternoon

## Room A

Toward Resilient, and  
Ethical Viable Systems  
(1)

## Room B

Emerging Methods and  
Tools (1)

## Room C

Stafford Beer in Latin  
America

## Room D

Cybernetics for All  
(Barefoot Cybernetics)  
(1)

13.00 - 14.00

### Lunch

14.00 - 14:45

**Constantin Malik**  
Designing Freedom.  
Still. And again

**Stephen McGibbon**  
Embracing the Black  
Box: Why Unexplainable  
AI (x<sup>7</sup>AI") is a Vital  
Feature of the Viable  
System's Algedonic  
Channel

**Mateus Van Stralen,  
Juliana Alves, Jose  
Dos Santos Cabral,  
Allenna Leonard**  
From Confluence to  
Emergence: What Ouro  
Preto Made Possible ASC  
2026 – Reflections,  
Outcomes and New  
Pathways

**Franz Spengler**  
How do viable systems  
emerge? Algedonic  
origins in the case of  
Swedish collective  
bargaining

14:45-15:30

**Wolfgang Lassi**  
From Values to  
Organizational Practice -  
the Contribution of the  
VSM to value-oriented  
leadership in the age of  
digitalization

**Andreas Slogar**  
"The Journey of LaCoCa  
- A Crew Sets Sail!" -  
Gamification Makes the  
VSM an Experience - No  
Theory Required  
(workshop)

**Bruno Vaz**  
Viable Space  
Governance in Latin  
America: A Processual  
Reading through Beer's  
VSM

**Thomas A.J.  
Biedermann**  
Gameful Experiences for  
Hopeful Futures:  
CyberNations  
(workshop)

15.30 - 16.00

### Coffee

16.00 - 16:30

**Katharine N. Farrell,  
Jon Walker, Ed van  
der Winden &  
(posthumously) Brian  
Lederer**  
Don't shoot the cat  
(workshop)

**Ayham Fattoum**  
When Viable Systems  
Fail: Explaining the Gap  
Between Diagnosis and  
Practice (workshop)

**Zeltzin Pérez-  
Matamoros, Ricardo  
Tejeida-Padilla &  
Isaías Badillo-Piña**  
Governance in the  
Magdalena River  
Community from the  
Postulates of the Viable  
System Model  
(workshop)

**Tom Chan**  
'Se hace camino al  
andar': barefoot  
cybernetic pathmaking  
to Stafford Beer

16:30-17:00

**Miguel Garcia Matas**  
Design of a Cybernetic  
Governance Framework  
for Platform Tokenomics

17.00 - 17.45

**Louis Klein (IFSR)**  
(keynote)  
Diagnosing the System  
for Systems Research:  
Recognising and  
Realising a Field in Itself  
and for Itself

**Michael Ben Eli**  
(keynote)  
Systems Thinking and  
Cybernetics -- the  
Missing Link in the  
Sustainability Discourse

**H. Palmarola, E.  
Medina & P.L. Alonso**  
Video about the  
Cybersyn Exhibition  
(edited by S Paredes)  
  
Closure of Latin Amerian  
Stream:  
**Jose C Mariategui**  
Governance and the  
Politics of Possibility

**José dos Santos  
Cabral Filho & Ana  
Paula Baltazar dos  
Santos**  
Architecture for  
Freedom: Syntegrity as  
an Educational Practice

# Friday September 18th

**Room A**  
The World in Torment

**Room B**  
Emerging Methods &  
Tools (2) AI, LLMs &  
Agentic Systems

**Room B**  
Barefoot Cybernetics (2)

**Room D**  
Innovations in VSM  
Theory

09.00 – 09.45

**Francesco Caputo**  
Building upon the  
Project Cybersyn:  
CyberSystemic  
Management for  
blending Structural  
Cybernetics and  
Relational Consonance  
(keynote)

**José Pérez Ríos**  
A Cybernetic  
Architecture for AI  
Governance: Integrating  
Identity, VSM, and  
Organizational  
Pathologies

**Jon Walker**  
Towards new economic  
and social structures for  
a collaborative, post-  
capitalistic society

**Tadeja Jere Jakulin**  
The Škofja Loka Passion  
Play as a Nexus of  
System, Culture, Art and  
Religion

09.45 – 10.30

**German Bula Escobar**  
Beer's Thought in the  
Colombian Comptroller  
General Project: Beyond  
Detecting Corruption—  
Designing Viable Public  
Institutions through  
Organizational  
Cybernetics (keynote)

**Pedram Farschtschian  
& Louis Harel**  
Bridging PIMS Data and  
Cybernetics: An  
Externally Anchored  
Operations Room

**Theodor Sarafidis**  
Artificial intelligence as a  
liberty machine. A  
metamodelization of  
barefoot cybernetics

**Richard Gunther**  
From Evidence to  
Inquiry: Keeping LLM  
Inference Provisional in  
Recursive VSM Diagnosis

10.30 - 11.00

**Coffee**

11.00 – 11.45

**Raul Espejo**  
Insufficient Variety and  
Artificial Intelligence

**Alejandro Fernandez**  
OpenSoma: A Decolonial  
Cybernetic Agent A  
Working System in the  
Line of Descent from  
Project Cybersyn

**Lien Peeters & Benny  
Corvers**  
Rethinking  
Organisational  
Networks: Practical  
Insights from Applying  
the Viable System Model  
in Real World  
Ecosystems

**Pedro Pablo Cardoso**  
Designing Viable  
Identity in Institutional  
Transitions: A VSM  
Reconstruction of the  
Total Veteran  
Framework

11.45 – 12.30

**Igor Perko**  
CyberSystemic Model  
Creation Protocol: AI-  
energy-climate-health  
governance case

**Ricardo Vega Mora**  
Cybersyn Boxes.  
Prototyping a Document  
Visualisation Assisted by  
AI

**Andrew Pickering**  
Ponds, politics and  
the east: Stafford  
Beer's cybernetics - a  
wider view  
(Keynote)

**Nour Abida**  
Can Stafford Beer Help  
Save Journalism?  
Applying the Viable  
System Model to  
Understand Resilience in  
Public Service Media

12:30 – 13:30

**Lunch**

# Friday September 18th – afternoon/evening

**Room A**  
The World in Torment

**Room B**  
Emerging Methods &  
Tools (2) AI, LLMs &  
Agentic Systems

**Room B**  
Barefoot Cybernetics (2)

**Room D**  
Innovations in VSM  
Theory

12:30 – 13:30 **Lunch**

13.30 – 14:00

## Plenary - WOSC "The World in Torment: A Time Whose Ideas Must Come" I Perko, F Caputo, A Reyes

14:00 - 14.30

**Taja Macek & Tadeja Jere Jakulin**  
Toward viability:  
applying the Viable  
System Model to the  
cruise shorescape

**Steve Outtrim & David J. Teece**  
The Next 100 Years of  
Stafford Beer: A  
Working Viable System  
Model for the Agentic AI  
Era

**Mateus van Stralen**  
From Cybersyn to the  
City: Variety  
Engineering and the  
Design of Open Urban  
Infrastructures

**Krishan Mathis**  
The Speed Gap -  
Translating the Viable  
System Model for a New  
Generation of  
Practitioners

14.30 - 15:00

**Cristina Cervino & Francesco Caputo, Igor Perko**  
Taming the Digital  
Beast: Variety  
Engineering and the  
Quest for Techno-  
Eustress

**Katherine Farrell**  
Purposive AI for the 21st  
Century Sustainable  
University

**Terence Love**  
Viable for Whom?  
Contested Identity in the  
VSM

**Thomas McEvoy-Zafiropulos**  
Diagnosing the System  
of the Self: Logical  
Closure, Normative  
Identity, and Existential  
Viability

14.45

15:00 - 15:30

**Fabiana Sepe & Simone Luongo, Giovanna Del Gaudio, Mario Tani, Gianpaolo Basile**  
Toward resilient and  
ethical viable tourism  
systems: a cybernetic  
view on marginal areas  
digital transformation in  
Italy

15:30 - 16:00

**Coffee**

16:00 - 16:30

**Maria Giovanna Corrado**  
Organizational  
Cybernetics in the Age  
of AI: Toward an  
Epistemic Conception of  
Viability

**Krishan Mathis, Margeret Heath, Panos Panagiotis**  
Cybernetic Futures  
(workshop)

**Robin Asby & Penny Marrington**  
Cybernetics of  
Community  
Development – A TEAM  
(Thinking with Every  
Available Mind) Activity  
(workshop)

**Jonathan Huxley**  
A full software  
implementation of  
Stafford Beer's Viable  
System Model (VSM) as  
a complete enterprise  
management system  
(workshop)

16:30 - 17:00

**Maurizio Tomasella**  
Charting the Boundaries  
of Accountability for  
Enhanced Airport  
Operational Resilience

17:00 - 18:30

## Plenary – Digital Museum/Video Documentaries Screening A Espinosa, B Angelov, J Walker, V Beer, A Leonard, G Filewod, B Vaz

20.00 - 23.00

**Gala Dinner (Toast to Stafford Beer)**

# Saturday September 19th

**Room A**  
Organisational Systems  
(VSM, CST, etc.)

**Room B**  
(3) Innovations in VSM  
theory

**Room C**  
Toward Resilient, and  
Ethical Viable Systems  
(2)

**Room D**  
(2d) Innovations in VSM  
Practice

09.00 – 09.15 **Reception**

|               |                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                          |
|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 09.15 - 10.00 | <b>Mike Jackson</b><br>Elevating Stafford Beer's<br>Legacy: A Critical<br>Systems Thinking<br>Perspective on the<br>Viable System Model                                                                | <b>Jan de Visch</b><br>The Art of Boundary-<br>Making: Deepening the<br>VSM through Cognitive-<br>Developmental Science | <b>Amar KJR Nayak</b><br>Ecosystemic<br>Transdisciplinary<br>Action Research: An<br>AIESS-Based<br>Methodology for<br>Regenerative<br>Organisational<br>Cybernetics                                                 | <b>Carola Ritzinger-Roll</b><br>From viability to<br>measurability –<br>Designing governance<br>structures in highly<br>complex and regulated<br>organisational contexts |
| 10.00 - 10.45 | <b>Gary Evans, Petter<br/>Øglund &amp; Jens<br/>Kaasbøll</b><br>Reclaiming Emancipation<br>in Critical Systems<br>Thinking: Using the<br>Double Viable System<br>Model to Identify the<br>Central Game | <b>Steve Brewis</b><br>Languaging an Adaptive<br>Organisation into<br>Existence: from Surprise<br>to Causal Closure     | <b>Chris Hamlin, Penny<br/>Hamlin &amp; Frank<br/>Hemmes</b><br>From Building a Regime<br>to Running It: A<br>Participatory Viable<br>System Model<br>Diagnostic of a<br>Regulator Entering Dual-<br>Mode Operation | <b>Ben Wood</b><br>Designing Heterarchy:<br>An Extension of the<br>Viable System Model for<br>Complex Construction<br>Projects.                                          |

10.45 - 11.15 **Coffee**

|               |                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                          |
|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 11.15 - 12.00 | <b>Roelien Goede &amp; Gary<br/>Smith</b><br>Foundations in Dialogue:<br>Comparing VSM and<br>CSH through<br>Checkland's FMA<br>Framework                         | <b>Ivo Velitchkov</b><br>Autonomy and cohesion                                                                              | <b>Carlos Andrés Mejía<br/>Beltrán</b><br>Exchange Ecologies and<br>Existential Conductivity:<br>A Cybernetic Framework<br>for Hybrid Human<br>Systems        | <b>Leon Bellin</b><br>The Social Movement of<br>Tomorrow: Sharing<br>Practical VSM<br>Application<br>(one hour workshop) |
| 12:00-12:45   | <b>Camilo Osejo Bucheli</b><br>Temporal Freedom in<br>Viable Systems: A<br>Genealogical Analysis of<br>Human and Machine<br>Time in Organisational<br>Cybernetics | <b>Marcus Barrick</b><br>Enactive Viable Agency:<br>A Process Relational<br>Grammar for Meta-<br>Cybernetics and the<br>VSM | <b>Sascha Kullak</b><br>HEX-VSM — an idea for<br>a serious game: "How<br>do we shape our<br>organisations so that<br>they heal us more than<br>they harm us?" |                                                                                                                          |

12:45 - 13.45 **Lunch**

13.45 – 14:00 Final session - Introduction

14:00 – 16:00 **World Café: Pathways forward**

16:00 - 16.15 **Closing Remarks & Farewell**